Writing this essay changed the way I think about education because it made me consider learning from both the teacher's and the student's perspectives. Before engaging with these readings, I mainly thought of education as transferring knowledge from someone who understands a subject to someone who is still learning it. I now see that the relationship between the teacher and student can be just as important.

Cushman (2003) especially influenced my thinking because Fires in the Bathroom gives students an opportunity to explain what they actually need from their teachers. The students discuss respect, fairness, trust, clear expectations, and the importance of teachers getting to know them as individuals. This made me realize that listening to students is not separate from teaching, it can actually make someone a better teacher. Students experience the classroom every day, so their perspectives can reveal problems and opportunities that an educator might otherwise overlook.

Delpit (2012) made me reflect on a different responsibility educators have: believing in the intellectual ability of every student. Her discussion of expectations, particularly for African American children, demonstrates how assumptions about students can influence the education they receive. What stood out to me was the idea that recognizing students' backgrounds and experiences should not mean expecting less from them. Teachers should understand where their students come from while still challenging them to achieve at a high level.

Together, these readings helped me understand that effective teaching requires a balance. Students need to feel heard and respected, but they also need to be challenged. They need guidance from an educator, but they also need opportunities to think independently and participate in their own learning. If I become an educator, I would want my students to leave my classroom with more than information. I would want them to feel that their ideas matter, that they are capable of difficult things, and that learning is something they can continue doing throughout their lives.

Refrences

Cushman, K. (2003). *Fires in the bathroom: Advice for teachers from high school students*. The New Press.

Delpit, L. (2012). *"Multiplication is for white people": Raising expectations for other people's children*. The New Press.